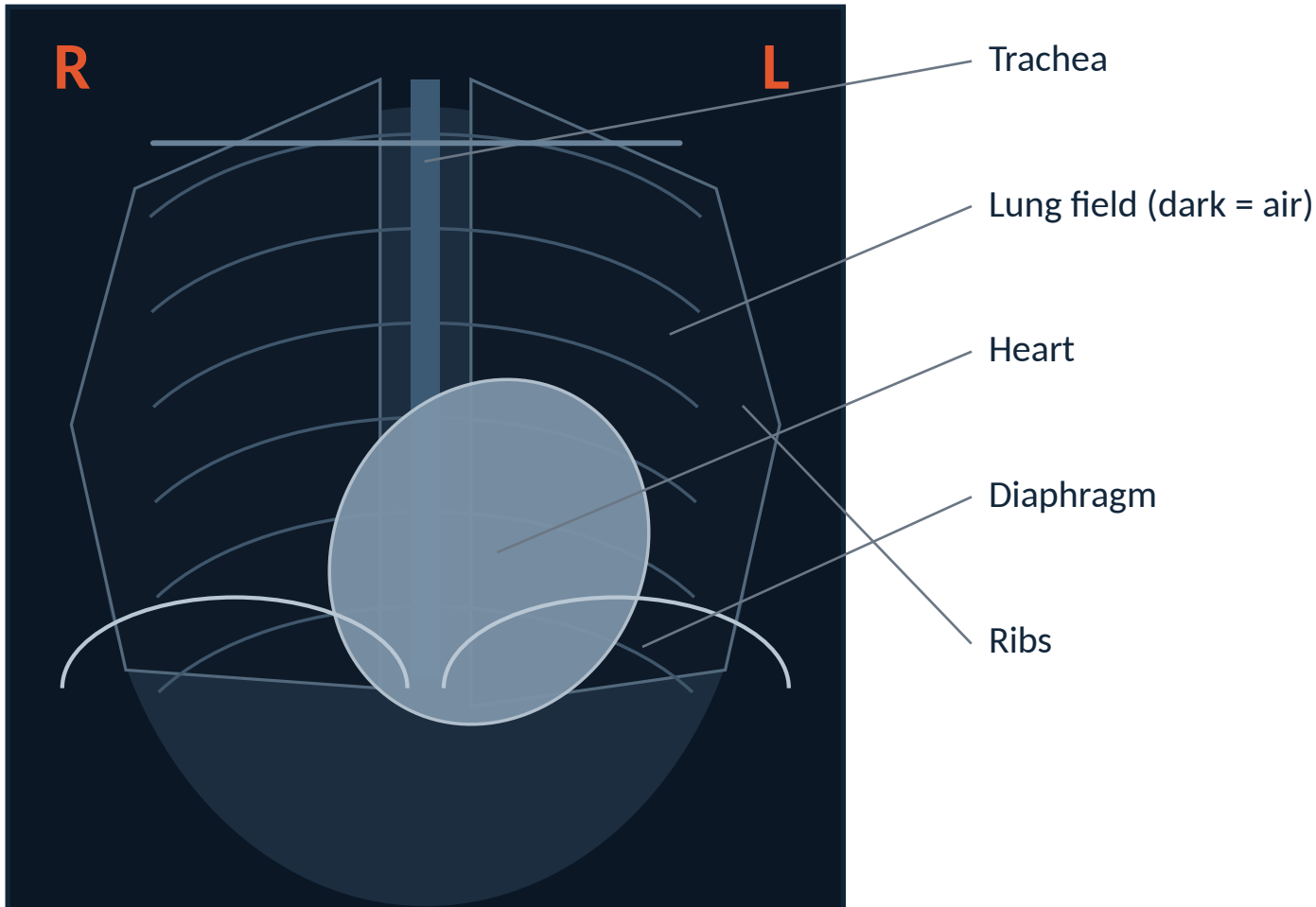

patient's right appears on the image's left

What a radiologist looks for

Cardiomegaly

heart wider than half the chest (cardiothoracic ratio > 0.5)

Pleural effusion

fluid blunts the sharp corner at the lung base

Pneumothorax

air outside the lung: dark area with no lung markings

Atelectasis

collapsed lung looks whiter; structures pull toward it